as-is interface

one screen interface of to-be

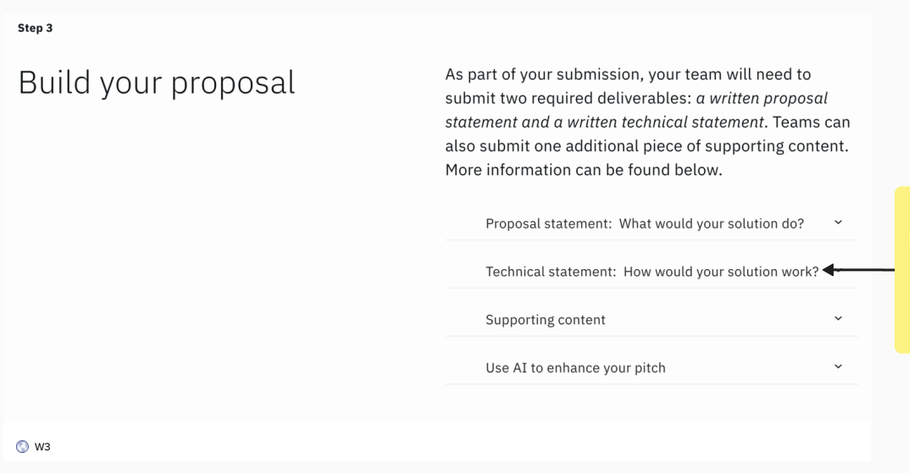
one screen of to-be expense report

system gets to know me

creates an interenary/ expense report based on profile and collegues on trip

Approve or edit. Go on trip.

Managing the expenses into the expense report



Step 3

Build your proposal

As part of your submission, your team will need to submit two required deliverables: *a written proposal statement and a written technical statement*. Teams can also submit one additional piece of supporting content. More information can be found below.

Proposal statement: What would your solution do?
Technical statement: How would your solution work?
Supporting content
Use AI to enhance your pitch
W3

Technical: We will leverage APIs to enable agentic workers to autonomously perform tasks related to trip planning and setup for IBM employees.

How would we define the value prop of this AI application?

Show the timeline of first time use, pick everything, to 20 use where AI has created an itenarary and I approve.

The AI Agents: License to Skill

Create Mural for a workshop based on provided criteria

Help me identify funnels in my product

Help me identify funnels in my product

WatsonX Conquer

"Meet your agent"	User specific instructions - profile	Initiate trip details	Create expense report	Help booking flight	Help with booking hotel	Help booking rental car	Help booking team events	Help getting IBM/ Manager pre-approval	Help documenting purchases	Help submitting expense report
Tell them all about yourself to define persona	Selectable persona			Fit to my schedule	Close to where I need it to be	Fit to my schedule	Finding a nearby place to take team/ clients		Asks for photo of receipt	
Show it all other expense reports				Find IBM approved flights	Knows areas of interest	Preferred rental company	Budget considerations		Memo about what purchase was for	
				Reserve a seat with my preferences	IBM approved hotels				Identify per diem	
				Preferred airline						

https://expenseai.app/

A successful submission will:
- Unlock time and talent within our Growth Enablers for high-value, strategic work
- Promote ease of use and ease of access for IBMers and clients
- Enable smarter decisions and better investments through data and automation

something about flight recommendations

Default style
A default style agent relies on the intrinsic tool call abilities of the LLM. A default agent just follows instructions as commanded, and adheres to the tools that are available to it.

React style
A react style agent relies on the prompting strategy outlined by the ReAct paper. This style of agent is capable of outputting the Chain of Thought into the agent response.

Planner style
A planner style agent is capable of customizing the response output. To define a planner agent, you must define either a structured_output field or a custom_join_tool field, as follows:

External Agents
External agents are built outside watsonx Orchestrate and can be used as collaborators for native agents.

watsonx Conquer Travel

Slide 1: Personal Preference Agent

Problem
- Preference of airline, rewards programs
- Dietary restrictions
- Accessibility & personal accommodations
- Feels impersonal

Solution
- Recommendations based on lifestyle (fun/quiet)
- Tailors options to fit your tastes
- Recommends personalized upgrades
- Maximize loyalty rewards

Slide 2: Travel Itinerary Agent

Problem
- Policies change each year
- Approvals can shift by destination
- Non-compliant purchases take extra time from everyone involved

Solution
- Maximize team coordination and travel efficiency
- Collaborates with Personal Preference Agent to recommend travel options that are approved AND match your preferences
- Maximize per diem amounts with coordinated restaurant recommendations
- Recommends hotels and restaurants close by your destination & stay within budgets

Slide 3: Expense Report Agent

Problem
- Missing receipts creates approval challenges
- Pre-approval step can be missed
- Complicated and time-consuming process to submit expense reports
- Excess time spent reviewing policies and guidelines
- Currency conversions make submissions more complicated

Solution
- Interact with travelers to collect receipt images and memos in the moment
- Adapt expenses to the correct currencies for submission
- Find related receipts from your IBM email
- Integrate with third-party agents: Uber,

1. **Personal Preference Agent:** This agent learns from individual user preferences, and past travel patterns to recommend personalized travel options.
2. **Travel Itinerary Agent:** This agent recommends a complete itinerary, with flight, hotel and dining options that fit with IBM corporate policies for your upcoming trip. When possible, it can identify overlapping itineraries and suggest shared transport or accommodation options.
3. **Expense Report Agent:** This agent drafts expense reports based on approved travel selections, automatically categorizing and summing expenses. It also integrates with receipt parsing technology to extract details and populate the report.

The Problem

Booking travel for work can feel like a full-time job in itself. You're juggling flight options that never quite align with your schedule, hotel availability that vanishes the moment you find something decent, and rental car pick-up times that somehow always conflict with your arrival. Each step is a maze of comparison sites, corporate policies, and last-minute changes. And just when you think the hard part is over, the expense report looms. You dig through crumpled receipts, decipher cryptic charges, and try to remember if that airport coffee was personal or business. It's a tedious, time-consuming process that turns every trip into a logistical headache before, during, and long after you've returned.

1. **Personal Preference Agent**

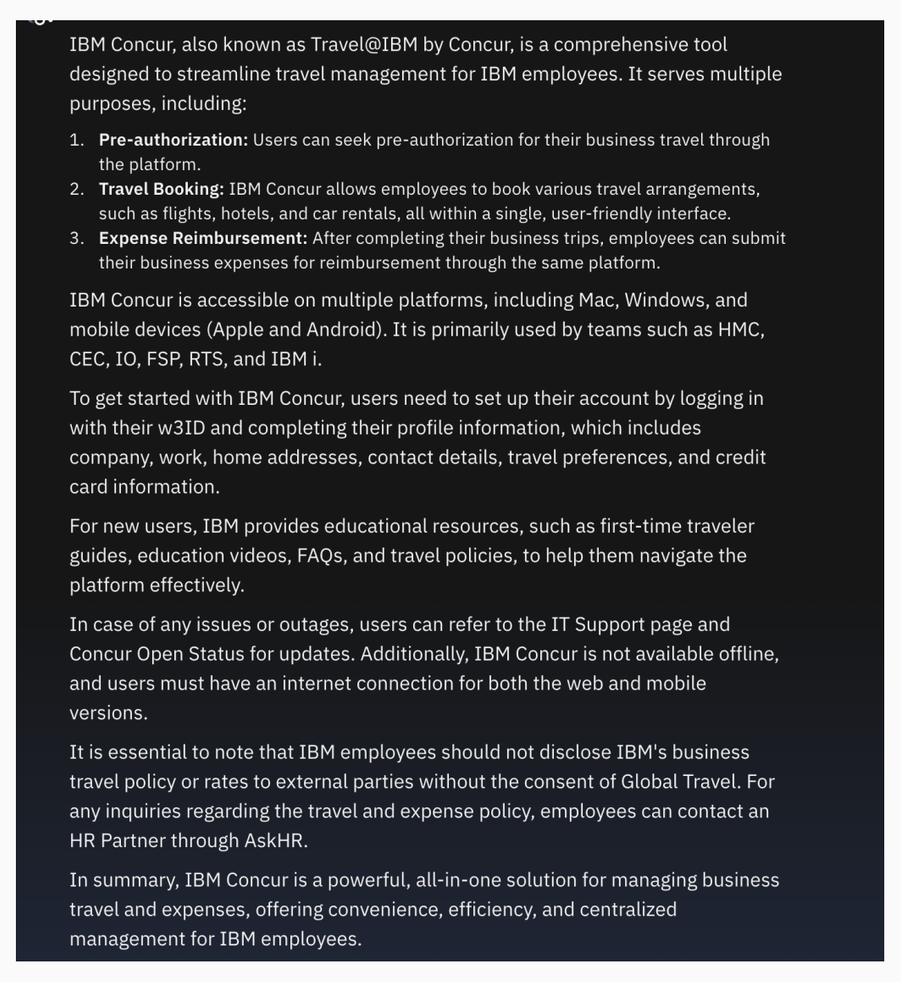
2. **Travel Itinerary Agent**

3. **Expense Report Agent:** This agent drafts expense reports based on approved travel selections, automatically categorizing and summing expenses. It also integrates with receipt parsing technology to extract details and populate the report.

When I asked what Concur was...

IBM Concur, also known as Travel@IBM by Concur, is a comprehensive tool designed to streamline travel management for IBM employees. It serves multiple purposes, including:
1. **Pre-authorization:** Users can seek pre-authorization for their business travel through the platform.
2. **Travel Booking:** IBM Concur allows employees to book various travel arrangements, such as flights, hotels, and car rentals, all within a single, user-friendly interface.
3. **Expense Reimbursement:** After completing their business trips, employees can submit their business expenses for reimbursement through the same platform.

IBM Concur is accessible on multiple platforms, including Mac, Windows, and mobile devices (Apple and Android). It is primarily used by teams such as HMC, CEC, IO, FSP, RTS, and IBM i.
To get started with IBM Concur, users need to set up their account by logging in with their w3ID and completing their profile information, which includes company, work, home addresses, contact details, travel preferences, and credit card information.
For new users, IBM provides educational resources, such as first-time traveler guides, education videos, FAQs, and travel policies, to help them navigate the platform effectively.
In case of any issues or outages, users can refer to the IT Support page and Concur Open Status for updates. Additionally, IBM Concur is not available offline, and users must have an internet connection for both the web and mobile versions.
It is essential to note that IBM employees should not disclose IBM's business travel policy or rates to external parties without the consent of Global Travel. For any inquiries regarding the travel and expense policy, employees can contact an HR Partner through AskHR.
In summary, IBM Concur is a powerful, all-in-one solution for managing business travel and expenses, offering convenience, efficiency, and centralized management for IBM employees.



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IBM Concur is accessible on multiple platforms, including Mac, Windows, and mobile devices (Apple and Android). It is primarily used by teams such as HMC, CEC, IO, FSP, RTS, and IBM i.

To get started with IBM Concur, users need to set up their account by logging in with their w3ID and completing their profile information, which includes company, work, home addresses, contact details, travel preferences, and credit card information.

For new users, IBM provides educational resources, such as first-time traveler guides, education videos, FAQs, and travel policies, to help them navigate the platform effectively.

In case of any issues or outages, users can refer to the IT Support page and Concur Open Status for updates. Additionally, IBM Concur is not available offline, and users must have an internet connection for both the web and mobile versions.

It is essential to note that IBM employees should not disclose IBM's business travel policy or rates to external parties without the consent of Global Travel. For any inquiries regarding the travel and expense policy, employees can contact an HR Partner through AskHR.

In summary, IBM Concur is a powerful, all-in-one solution for managing business travel and expenses, offering convenience, efficiency, and centralized management for IBM employees.

Personal preference agent

Problems

Summary

1. **Lack of Preferred Airline and Rewards Program Association:** IBM travel policies do not allow for the use of preferred airlines or rewards programs, which can lead to dissatisfaction among travelers who value these benefits.
2. **Dietary Restrictions:** Travelers with specific dietary restrictions may face challenges when booking meals during their trips, as IBM's travel booking tool may not accommodate these needs effectively.
3. **Accessibility and Personal Accommodations:** IBM's travel policies require all business travel to be booked in economy class. Employees with specific needs, such as those requiring a modified device or a non-standard laptop, may face difficulties in obtaining necessary accommodations.
4. **Impersonal Booking Experience:** The use of IBM's Travel@IBM (Concur) tool for booking travel can feel impersonal, as it does not offer the same level of personalized service that some travelers may prefer when arranging their trips.

These are a bit long...

Solution

- **Airline, Hotel, and Restaurant Recommendations**: Personalized suggestions based on per diem and proximity to the hotel.
- **Tailored Options**: Customized choices according to user's lifestyle preferences (fun/quiet).
- **Personalized Upgrades**: Recommendations for enhanced travel experiences.
- **Maximized Loyalty Rewards**: Optimization of rewards programs for increased benefits.

Solutions

1. **Tailored Options:** Offer personalized choices for airlines, hotels, travel, and restaurants based on users' lifestyle preferences (e.g., fun or quiet) while ensuring cost-effectiveness, such as per diem on food.
2. **Personalized Upgrades:** Provide recommendations for upgraded travel experiences tailored for after-work hours.
3. **Maximized Loyalty Rewards:** Optimize rewards programs to increase benefits for users.

1. Annual policy updates in IBM Concur can cause confusion and require frequent adjustments, as some countries have specific exceptions to the policy.
2. Approval processes for business travel expenses may vary by destination, leading to inconsistencies and delays.
3. Non-compliant purchases, such as those made outside of IBM's travel policy, necessitate additional time and effort from all parties involved for review and approval.
4. Unclear guidelines on actions upon arrival, such as meal per diem rates, can result in uncertainty and potential issues for travelers.

Policy updates as-is

To understand yearly policy updates that occur in Concur, employees should regularly check the Travel@IBM website for any changes or updates to travel policies. Additionally, they can refer to the Global Expense Monitoring, Compliance and Analysis Program (GEMCAP) for information on policy compliance and any necessary education or direction on travel policies. Employees should also be aware of any targeted emails or phone calls from GEMCAP regarding policy updates.

Travel itinerary agent

Problems

1. Policies change each year: Concur's travel policies are subject to annual updates, which may not always be immediately reflected in the system. This can lead to users booking travel that does not comply with the current policy, causing delays and potential rework.
2. Approvals can shift by destination: Concur's approval workflows can vary based on the destination of the trip. This inconsistency can create confusion for users, as they may need to navigate different approval processes for different trips, potentially leading to errors or delays in booking.
3. Non-compliant purchases take extra time from everyone involved: If a user books a non-compliant purchase in Concur, it may require additional time and effort from both the user and the approver to rectify the issue. This can lead to inefficiencies and delays in the travel booking process.

None of the solutions mention an itinerary. Should I add that as a solution into ask IBM?

1. Streamline Team Coordination: The solution involves collaborating with a Personal Preference Agent to suggest travel options that align with both approval guidelines and your personal preferences. This ensures a balance between adhering to company policies and catering to individual needs.
2. Optimize Per Diem Utilization: The system maximizes per diem amounts by providing coordinated restaurant recommendations. This feature helps users make the most of their daily allowance while enjoying a variety of dining options.
3. Budget-Conscious Accommodation and Dining: The solution recommends hotels and restaurants located near your destination, ensuring convenience and staying within budget constraints. This feature helps users save money and time by minimizing travel between accommodation and dining locations.

1. Streamline Team Coordination and Travel Efficiency: Implement a standardized travel approval process for Sales, Consulting, Infrastructure, and Research teams to optimize resource allocation and balance costs, time, and resources for events like Think 2024.
2. Policy Compliance and Simplified User Experience: Update Concur options to ensure users adhere to company policies without requiring them to search for information repeatedly. This will enhance user experience and maintain compliance.
3. Personalized Travel Recommendations: Collaborate with a Personal Preference Agent to suggest travel options that align with your preferences while adhering to company policies and guidelines.
4. Optimize Per Diem Amounts: Coordinate restaurant recommendations to help maximize per diem amounts, ensuring you make the most of your allocated budget.
5. Budget-Conscious Accommodation and Dining: Recommend hotels and restaurants near your destination that fit within your budget, allowing you to plan your trip more effectively and stay within financial limits.

Solutions

1. Maximize team coordination and travel efficiency: By providing a full travel itinerary, Concur can enhance team coordination and travel efficiency. This feature would allow users to view all aspects of their trip in one place, including flights, accommodations, and ground transportation. This consolidated view would streamline the booking process, reduce the likelihood of errors, and enable users to make more informed decisions about their travel arrangements.
2. Collaborate with Personal Preference Agent: Concur could integrate a Personal Preference Agent that recommends travel options tailored to individual preferences while ensuring compliance with company policies. This feature would help users find suitable travel arrangements that align with their preferences, such as preferred airlines, hotel chains, or seating classes, while adhering to corporate travel guidelines.
3. Maximize per diem amounts with coordinated restaurant recommendations: A full travel itinerary could include coordinated restaurant recommendations that help users maximize their per diem amounts. By suggesting dining options that are both cost-effective and compliant with company policies, Concur can assist users in optimizing their meal expenses and ensuring they stay within budget.
4. Recommend hotels and restaurants close by your destination & stay within budgets: Concur could provide users with hotel and restaurant recommendations that are geographically close to their destination, helping them save time and money on transportation. Additionally, these recommendations would be filtered to ensure they fall within the approved budget, further enhancing compliance and cost-effectiveness.

By implementing these features, Concur can significantly improve the travel booking experience for users, leading to increased efficiency, better compliance with company policies, and cost savings.

Expense Report Agent

Problems

1. Missing receipts create approval challenges: When employees fail to submit all necessary receipts with their expense reports, it can lead to approval delays and potential rejections. This issue can cause frustration for both employees and approvers, as it requires additional time and effort to resolve.
2. Pre-approval step can be missed: Concur's expense reporting process includes a pre-approval step, which is crucial for ensuring compliance with company policies. If this step is overlooked, it can result in non-compliant expenses being submitted, leading to potential audits and rework.
3. Complicated and time-consuming process to submit expense reports: The current expense reporting process in Concur can be complex and lengthy, requiring employees to navigate multiple screens and input various details. This complexity can lead to user errors and increased time spent on completing expense reports.
4. Excess time spent reviewing policies and guidelines: Employees may spend a significant amount of time reviewing company travel and expense policies and guidelines to ensure compliance. This time-consuming process can detract from their primary work responsibilities and contribute to overall inefficiency.
5. Currency conversions make submissions more complicated: When employees submit expenses incurred in foreign currencies, they must manually convert the amounts to their home currency. This manual process can be prone to errors and adds an extra layer of complexity to the expense reporting process.

By addressing these issues, Concur can streamline the expense reporting process, making it more user-friendly, efficient, and compliant with company policies.

Solutions

1. Interact with travelers to collect receipt images and memos in the moment: By enabling users to upload receipt images and memos directly from their phones to Concur, the expense reporting process becomes more convenient and immediate. This feature reduces the need for manual data entry and minimizes the risk of lost or misplaced receipts.
2. Adapt expenses to the correct currencies for submission: Automatically converting expenses to the appropriate currencies for submission eliminates the need for manual currency conversions. This feature not only saves time but also reduces the likelihood of errors, ensuring accurate and compliant expense reports.
3. Automatically import receipts from email into Concur: By integrating with email services, Concur can automatically import hotel and ride-sharing receipts (e.g., Uber) sent via email. This feature streamlines the expense reporting process, as users no longer need to manually enter or upload receipts, reducing the time and effort required to complete expense reports.
4. Integrate with third-party agents (Uber, hotels, airlines): By partnering with third-party agents, Concur can provide users with seamless access to their travel and expense data. This integration enables users to automatically import travel bookings and related expenses, further simplifying the expense reporting process and ensuring compliance with company policies.

By implementing these features, Concur can significantly improve the user experience for employees submitting expense reports, making the process more efficient, accurate, and compliant with company policies.